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(1) Extension Program/ Project Title: The Digi-Turismo Project: Modernizing Marketing for Local Handicraft Producers	
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(2) Category (please check) ☐ Education and Humanities ☒ Agriculture/Fisheries/<u>Livelihood</u> ☐ Health/Environment ☐ Engineering and Technology
(4) Background (WHAT, WHERE is the proposed project, WHO will benefit, what PRODUCT/SERVICE will address the identified needs/resources. Introduce the product/service that will address the identified needs and resources (general statement). Introduce the target group, organization/community to be served, and the project beneficiaries briefly. Include related literature consistent with the subject – to make the proposal scholarly) The DIGI-TURISMO Project combines traditional craftsmanship with modern technology to bridge the gap between the past and the present. It enables local handicraft producers to adapt to the evolving marketing landscape while staying true to their traditions and heritage. Through digital platforms, local handicraft producers can showcase their products to a wider audience, fostering economic growth and cultural appreciation. The DIGI-TURISMO project under the TURISMO PROGRAM of the Tourism Management Department is a project conceptualized for the local handicraft producers in the Municipality of Sigma which is the pilot locality of the project. These local handicraft producers are the Hanawa Weaving Association in Brgy. Matangcong, Sigma, Capiz who makes buri bags, wallets, and baskets. Also, Bamboo craft producers in Brgy. Mangoso, Sigma, Capiz who makes bamboo furniture, and Nito craft producers in Brgy. Pinamalatican, Sigma, Capiz who makes different handicrafts out of Nito such as hats, bags and wallets. The DIGI-TURISMO Project is composed of different trainings and seminars such as tourism and cultural awareness forum, product packaging and labelling, online marketing (photography and social media), website making, basic bookkeeping with the integration of gender & sensitivity training, and values formation.

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(5) RATIONALE (WHY should the project be implemented? **WHAT need** is the project trying to address? – how the problem is affecting the targeted beneficiaries, previous efforts done and status, any legal bases and related literature supporting the proposed project, link the relevance of the project to development priorities like mandate and development goals, the comparative advantage to handle the project, and **WHY** act now and not later)

The DIGI-TURISMO Project is an innovative initiative aimed at modernizing marketing strategies for handicraft producers. It recognizes the challenges faced by these group in reaching a wider audience and maximizing their sales potential. By utilizing digital technologies and online platforms, the project will enable local handicraft producers to showcase and sell their products to a wider market and global customer base. Since, they usually brought it to the public market to directly sell their hand-made products. However, handicraft producers have low income or sales due to the limited reach of the market. It is in this vain, that the CAPSU Sigma Tourism Management Department has crafted the DIGI-TURISMO Project to help local handicraft producers find a platform to reach a wider market. In order to answer this need, the proponents see the potential of digitalization as a marketing tool to create awareness of the prospective market and to increase the profitability of their small business.

(6) GOALS AND OBJECTIVES (what do you **WANT TO ACHIEVE**? This presents what the proponent hopes to accomplish through the project and what can address the cause of the core problem. Captures changes in people's lives at the societal level – the **IMPACT**. The **BIG PICTURE**.)

The DIGI-TURISMO Project aims to:

1. To train at least twenty-five (25) local handicraft producers in the digitalization of their products in the market.
2. To assess the level of effectiveness of the current marketing tool used by local handicraft producers.
3. To help the local handicraft producers bring their products to a wider potential market.
4. To assist the local handicraft producers increased their income by capacitating with the necessary skills related to the latest method of marketing their products.

(7) PROJECT DESCRIPTION (what are the **features** of the project process/tools used in the project ID, location, duration, beneficiaries, results chain/framework, project cycle – [*needs/gaps identified, set of solutions noted to address the needs*])

The DIGI-TURISMO Project, aimed at transforming marketing strategies for local handicraft producers in the Municipality of Sigma. It is a pioneering initiative that combines digital technology with traditional handicraft producer skills. By creating an online platform where local handicraft producers can showcase their unique products to a global audience, this project not only increases market accessibility but also preserves cultural heritage. Through targeted digital marketing campaigns and e-commerce solutions, the Digi-Turismo Project empowers handicraft producers in the Municipality of Sigma to reach new customers and expand their businesses beyond local markets.

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(8) PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION AND Monitoring & Evaluation SYSTEM (how will the project be implemented, how will the project be tested if it is working, when - detailed activities to be undertaken by component to generate the outputs, support the description of activities through a matrix or work plan identifying how each activity will be delivered, who will be responsible for WHAT, WHEN, WHERE – state your Activities, Work Plan - Project Schedule supported with a Gantt chart, Project Management [proponent, partners and their roles and responsibilities including counter parting scheme, if any, capacity to handle the project, and accompany with the simple management structure. Provide theoretical background and apply it to the project. Describe how the project will be monitored and evaluated during the planning/pre-implementation, implementation, and operation/post-implementation phases. M&E framework must be accompanied by a **DATA Collection Plan**)

ACTIVITIES

Activities	Persons Involved	Date of Implementation
A. PRE-ASSESSMENT PHASE		April 2024
1. Consultative meeting with partner agencies	The Proponents/Facilitator LGU-Sigma Trainer Trainees Staff	
2. Assessment of the availability of technology resources		
3. Identifying possible linkages or sponsoring agency in the provision of technological resources		
4. Profiling of the participants		
5. Assessment of the effectiveness of the current marketing tool used by the clientele		
6. Exploring the challenges and difficulties of the local handicraft producers in marketing their products.		
7. Identifying experts in technology and in marketing.		
B. DESIGN PHASE		
1. Creation and validation of training design	Proponents/Facilitator Trainee	May 2024
2. Creation and validation of the modules and IEC /training materials		
C. IMPEMENTATION PHASE		
“Before”	The Proponents/Facilitator LGU-Sigma Trainee Trainees Staff	June-October 2024
1. Courtesy call with the head of partner agencies		
2. Launching, Orientation of the technical experts, facilitators, and beneficiaries and forging of MOA		June-October 2024
“During”	The Proponents/Facilitator LGU-Sigma Trainee Trainees Staff	November 2024
1. Implementation of the project		
2. Evaluation of the challenges of the extensionist in introducing modern technology and to clientele who are not skillful in handling new technology.		
“After”	The Proponents Staff	
1. Culminating Activity/Evaluation		
D. EVALUATION PHASE		
1. Monitoring activity		
2. Conduct of Impact Study		

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WORKPLAN

Activities	Quarter 1	Quarter 2	Quarter 3	Quarter 4
a. Pre-assessment Phase				
b. Design Phase				
c. Implementation Phase				
d. Evaluation Phase				

OUTPUTS AND IMPACTS

1. The level of effectiveness of the current marketing tool used by local handicraft producers will be assessed.
2. The twenty-five (25) local handicraft producers will be trained in improving the design and packaging of their products, as well as, be trained in marketing their products using the various digital platform.
3. The twenty-five (25) local handicraft producers will bring their products to the wider potential market using the digital platform.
4. The handicraft producers' income will be increased by 5% per annum.

MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The proponents will monitor the local handicraft producers every quarter to ensure the sustainability of the project.

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(9.) SUSTAINABILITY PLAN (All projects have limited time durations. Can the project be supported after its project life? How will the organization sustain the project in terms of dedicated staff? How will the beneficiaries continue to carry out the activities after the project? Is there any financial support required for the project after the project has ended?)

The DIGI-TURISMO Project, which aims to modernize the marketing of local handicraft producers, recognizes the importance of sustainability beyond its project life. To ensure that the project can be supported after its duration, the team has developed this sustainability plan.

1. The organization will establish a team that will continue to oversee and coordinate the activities even after the project ends. This team will be responsible for maintaining the project's momentum and ensuring its long-term success.
2. To ensure that the beneficiaries will continue to carry out the activities after the project, the team will provide resources in the form of manuals, guides, and tutorials. The project team plans to establish partnerships and networks with local businesses, organizations, and government agencies to create a supportive ecosystem for the beneficiaries. The team will also be providing 1 set of computer with printer and internet connection by finding sponsorship or donation from partner agencies and other linkages such as LGU-Sigma, PTCAO, DTI etc. This will help the beneficiaries sustain and expand the marketing initiatives independently beyond the project's completion.
3. The organization recognizes the need for continued funding even after the project ends. It will explore various avenues such as seeking additional grants, engaging in fundraising activities, and exploring revenue-generating opportunities. This financial support will ensure the sustainability and growth of the project, allowing it to have a lasting impact on the local handicraft producers and the community as a whole.

(10.) RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS - (a. Direct Costs – (Implementing team – manpower (who – names and positions, how many?, Facilities and Equipment needed, Supplies and Materials, Travel, Hauling, Etc) b. Indirect costs (rental, electricity, administrative cost 5% to 15%) c. Contingencies (price increases, unforeseen and emergency expenses) 5% of the direct cost, Budget)

Activities	Resource/Materials	Total Cost
A. PRE-ASSESSMENT PHASE		2,365.00
1. Consultative meeting with partner agencies	Snacks 40 pax x 50.00 = 2,000.00	
2. Assessment of the availability of technology resources	25 participants	
3. Identifying possible linkages or sponsoring agency in the provision of technological resources	10 Brgy. Officials	
4. Profiling of the participants	5 trainer/facilitator	
5. Assessment of the effectiveness of the current marketing tool used by the clientele	Training materials	
6. Exploring the challenges and difficulties of the local handicraft producers in marketing their products.		
7. Identifying experts in technology and in marketing.		
B. DESIGN PHASE		790.00
1. Creation and Validation of training design	Training materials	
2. Creation and validation of the modules and IEC/training materials		

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C. IMPLEMENTATION PHASE		99,000.00
“Before”		
1. Courtesy call with the head of partner agencies.	Snacks (AM, PM) 100.00x 40 x 4 days=16,000.00	
2. Launching, Orientation of the technical experts, facilitators, and beneficiaries and forging of MOA.	Lunch 250.00x 40x 4 days=40,000.00	
“During”		
3. Implementation of the project	Training Materials=43,000.00	
4. Evaluation of the challenges of the extensionist in introducing modern technology and to clientele who are not skillful in handling new technology.		
“After”		
1. Culminating Activity/Evaluation		
EVALUATION PHASE		
1. Monitoring activity		
2. Conduct of Impact Study	Training materials	1,000.00
TOTAL BUDGET		103,155.00

(11) Executive Summary (A significant part of the proposal. Summarize the project so that readers can rapidly become acquainted with the problem, background information, implementation scheme, and resource requirements. Intended as an aid to decision-making since it covers all sections, but do not copy and paste and write in the same order as the main document.)

The DIGI-TURISMO Project aims to revolutionize the marketing strategies utilized by local handicraft producers by leveraging digital tools and online platforms. This project addresses the pressing issue faced by these artisans in reaching a wider audience and competing in the modern market landscape. Local handicraft producers often struggle to promote their products beyond their immediate community due to limited access to digital marketing resources and platforms. This hinders their ability to expand their customer base and generate sustainable income from their craft.

The DIGI-TURISMO Project recognizes the intricate craftsmanship and cultural significance of local handicrafts. By bridging the gap between traditional artisanal practices and modern marketing techniques, this project aims to preserve heritage crafts while enabling artisans to thrive in the digital age.

Furthermore, digital marketing campaigns will be implemented to raise awareness about the unique stories behind each handicraft, thereby enhancing the perceived value of these products in the eyes of consumers.

The beneficiaries of the DIGI-TURISMO Project will be the local handicraft producers in the Municipality of Sigma. The DIGI-TURIMO Project will conduct a series of training on tourism and cultural awareness forum, product packaging and labelling, online marketing (photography and social media), website making, basic bookkeeping with the integration of gender & sensitivity training, and values formation. The project cost 103,155.00 that includes training materials, snacks and lunch of the beneficiaries, resource person and trainee, and facilitator during the duration of the training.